

Part I: “Definitions” (2pts each)

Explain **all five** of the following terms.

1. **Argument from design**
 2. **Analogical Reasoning**
 3. **Finkish disposition**
 4. **Intrinsic property**
 5. **Extrinsic disposition**
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Part II: Short Answer (10pts each)

Answer **5 of the following 7** questions.

Paley and Hume

1. Paley’s design argument begins with our experience of objects like watches. Explain how Paley moves from our recognition of design in human artifacts to the conclusion that we may recognize design in nature as a whole. What assumptions about inference from experience does this argument rely on?

2. Hume, through Philo, argues that the inference from designed human objects to the universe is much weaker than defenders of the design argument suppose. Explain Hume’s objection to this generalization. Why does he think our experience of houses, watches, and other artifacts does not justify a strong conclusion about the cause of the universe?

Lewis

3. Explain Martin’s counterexample to the simple conditional analysis of dispositions as Lewis understands it. What is a finkish disposition, and why does its possibility show that the simple analysis is false?

4. Lewis argues that dispositions are a matter of the intrinsic properties of a thing alone. Explain this claim and the reasoning behind it. In your answer, discuss one of Lewis’s examples that is meant to show why extrinsic factors should not count as part of the disposition itself.

5. Lewis does not think that adding a *ceteris paribus* clause to the original simple analysis will help it. Explain why not. What problem would such a clause be trying to solve, and why does Lewis think it is philosophically unsatisfactory?

McKitrick

6. McKitrick discusses the example of a key that can open a particular door. Explain how this example is supposed to show that a thing can gain or lose a disposition solely because of changes in its environment, even when its intrinsic properties remain unchanged.
7. McKitrick identifies four “marks of dispositionality.” What are they, and how does each one help us recognize when a property is dispositional?